Coast Life Constructions — 90-Day Instagram Strategy

Managed by 10x Visuals | Cycle: Jul–Sep 2026
Built from profile audit (see `00_profile_audit.md`)

Starting position (July 2026)

- **Current engagement:** 12–34 likes per post, 0–4 comments
- **Current audience:** Trade suppliers and subcontractors (roofers, pumpies)
- **Current pillar mix:** ~100% BTS/process, 0% finished builds, 0% design story
- **Current cadence:** ~1 post per 10 days, 11-week gap in Q1
- **Benchmark to reach in 90 days:** @barlowbuilding baseline — 50+ likes per post, mixed commenter base including designers/homeowners, warm-neutral consistent grid, every project named

Goal

Position Coast Life as the **premium, family-run, no-shortcuts builder of the Gold Coast** — the builder architects recommend and homeowners trust after being burned elsewhere.

The 12-month target is @barlowbuilding's positioning (architecture-led custom builder, named projects, editorial voice). The 3-year ceiling is @grimmondau (long-form YouTube ecosystem, single-word brand mark, 8k+ engaged followers).

Success metrics (track weekly):
- **Engagement per post:** 12–34 today → 40+ by day 90 (Barlow floor)
- **Comment mix:** at least 1 non-trade comment per week by day 60 (designer, homeowner, architect)
- **Follower growth:** +8–12%/month
- **Reel plays:** 2 Reels/month over 5k plays by day 90
- **Saves + shares:** track weekly, this is the real homeowner-intent signal
- **Consult enquiries from IG:** track via link-in-bio + "how did you hear"

The pillar rebalance (the single biggest strategic move)

Current (broken) mix: 100% BTS → attracts tradies, not homeowners.
Target mix:

Pillar	Current	Target	Format	Purpose
Finished-build showcases	0%	**40%**	Reels + carousels	Portfolio proof, homeowner aspiration — THIS IS THE MISSING PIECE
Behind-the-scenes / process	100%	25%	Reels + photos	Trust, craftsmanship, authenticity (keep, don't kill)
Design process & educational	0%	20%	Carousels	Saves, shares, authority — Barlow's "Translating intent into reality" territory
People / brand story	0%	15%	Reels + photos	Family-run warmth, differentiation

Why finished-builds are the priority: A homeowner researching Coast Life today sees zero completed homes. They cannot make a hiring decision from BTS content alone. Barlow's 136-like posts are almost all finished-build or design-story content. This is the ceiling being left on the table.

Weekly cadence (4 posts)

Day	Time (AEST)	Format	Pillar
Tue	7:00 am	Reel	Project showcase or BTS
Thu	6:30 pm	Carousel	Educational or project breakdown
Sat	9:00 am	Reel	BTS / people / process
Sun	5:00 pm	Single photo	Portfolio hero shot

90-day theme arc

Month 1 — "Name the builds" (Jul 2026)

Retroactively name and reintroduce the last 3 finished builds. Produce and pin the 3 anchor posts (see `pinned_posts.md`). Publish the first named-project reveal as a Reel. Every post from day 1 tags trade partners. Goal: shift the grid from anonymous BTS to named, credited work.

Month 2 — "How we actually build" (Aug 2026)

Deep-dive design and process content. Educational carousels on materials, cost realities, common mistakes. Bring in the "Translating intent into reality" cadence — people studying drawings, materials being selected, decisions being made. Goal: establish design authority and start pulling in non-trade commenters.

Month 3 — "Finished builds" (Sep 2026)

Full project reveals of two additional named builds. Cinematic walkthrough Reels. Before/after carousels. Client testimonial Reels if any handovers land in the window. Goal: convert warmed audience into consult bookings. Run 90-day re-audit against Barlow benchmarks.

Monthly production plan (batch-filmed once per month)

On-site batch day checklist:

- [ ] 3 project walkthroughs (locked-off, gimbal, drone if compliant)
- [ ] 5–10 close-up craftsmanship shots (materials, joinery, finishes)
- [ ] 2 talking-head clips with owner (60–90s each, teleprompter ready)
- [ ] Team candids on the tools
- [ ] Golden-hour exterior stills
- [ ] B-roll for AI-enhanced time-flow shots (day→night, feature reveals)

Reel formulas (rotate)

1. **The 15-second walkthrough** — Locked wide shot pans, cut on beat, one-line text overlay per shot.
2. **The material story** — Close-up + owner voice-over explaining the choice.
3. **The build timeline** — Time-flow cut showing weeks of progress in 20s.
4. **The mistake reel** — "Most builders skip this. Here's why we don't."
5. **The client hand-over** — Real reaction at final walkthrough (with consent).

Growth levers (in priority order)

1. **Tag trade partners in every post.** Barlow tags 8–10 per post; they reshare ~60% of the time. Coast Life tags zero today. This is the single biggest free reach lever available.
2. **Name every project.** Retroactively name the last 3 finished builds. Use the name in caption, hashtags, and story highlight. Compounds massively over 12 months.
3. **Add a location tag to every post.** Suburb-specific geo-tags drive local reach on the Gold Coast where clients are searching "builder + suburb."
4. **Reply to every comment in the first 60 min.** Algorithm boost + it turns tradie comments into micro-conversations that non-tradies scroll through.
5. **DM every save/share from a local account within 24 hours.** Warm outreach, no pitch — just "thanks for the share, if you're planning anything happy to chat."
6. **Watermark every finished-build Reel** with the Coast Life mark bottom-corner. Barlow-style, subtle.

Quarterly review (end of Sep)

- Which pillar drove the most saves? Rebalance mix.
- Which Reel formula converted best to profile visits? Double down.
- Which posts got shared to Stories by others? Those are your voice hits — clone the pattern.